MOOSE (Meta-analyses of Observational Studies in Epidemiology) Checklist

Item No	Recommendation	Reported on Page Number/Line Number	Reported on Section/Paragraph
Reporting of Background			
1	Problem definition	Page1/line30-31	Abstract/Paragraph9
2	Hypothesis statement	Page2/line15-17	Abstract/Paragraph3
3	Description of Study Outcome(s)	Page2/line4-14	Abstract/Paragraph2
4	Type of exposure or intervention used	N/A,No exposure or intervention was tested in	
5	Type of study design used	Page3/line6-8	Methods/Paragraph1
6	Study population	Page3/line7-14	Methods/Paragraph1
Reporting of Search Strategy			
7	Qualifications of searchers (eg, librarians and investigators)	Page3/line26-27	Methods/Paragraph3
8	Search strategy, including time period included in the synthesis and keywords	Page3/line18-23	Methods/Paragragh2
9	Effort to include all available studies, including contact with authors	Page13/line5-Page15/line1	Results/Paragragh1
10	Databases and registries searched	Page3/line21-22	Methods/Paragragh2
11	Search software used, name and version, including special features used (eg, explosion)	N/A We did not employ a search software EndNote	
12	Use of hand searching (eg, reference lists of obtained articles)	Page3/line19-23	Methods/Paragragh3
13	List of citations located and those excluded, including justification	Page17/line7-20	Results/Paragragh1
14	Method for addressing articles published in languages other than English	N/A;We palced to no restrictions to language;	
15	Method of handling abstracts and unpublished studies	Page3/28-29	Methods/Paragraph3
16	Description of any contact with authors	Page3/28-29	Methods/Paragraph3

Reporting of Methods			
17	Description of relevance or appropriateness of studies assembled for assessing the hypothesis to be tested	Page4/line6-15	Methods/paragargh1
18	Rationale for the selection and coding of data (eg, sound clinical principles or convenience)	Page4/line1-4	Methods/paragragh1
19	Documentation of how data were classified and coded (eg, multiple raters, blinding, and interrater reliability)	Page3/line26-30	Methods/paragargh3
20	Assessment of confounding (eg, comparability of cases and controls in studies where appropriate)	Page3/line8-15	Methods/paragargh1
21	Assessment of study quality, including blinding of quality assessors; stratification or regression on possible predictors of study results	Page4/5-16	Methods/paragargh2
22	Assessment of heterogeneity	Page4/line12-16	Methods/paragargh2
23	Description of statistical methods (eg, complete description of fixed or random effects models, justification of whether the chosen models account for predictors of study results, dose-response models, or cumulative meta-analysis) in sufficient detail to be replicated	Page4/line5-16	Methods/paragargh2
24	Provision of appropriate tables and graphics	Page13/line6-Page15/line1; Page15/line4-Page16/line5	Results/paragargh1 Results/paragargh2
Reporting of Results			
25	Graphic summarizing individual study estimates and overall estimate	Page17/line7-20	Results/paragargh1
26	Table giving descriptive information for each study included	Page13/line6-Page15/line1	Results/paragargh1
27	Results of sensitivity testing (eg, subgroup analysis)	Page4/line19-Page5/line27	Results/paragargh1
28	Indication of statistical uncertainty of findings	Page4/line19-Page5/line27	Results/paragargh1
Reporting of Discussion			
29	Quantitative assessment of bias (eg, publication bias)	Page8/line30-32	Discussion/paragragh6
30	Justification for exclusion (eg, exclusion of non–English-language citations)	Page17/line7-21	Results/paragargh1
31	Assessment of quality of included studies	Page5/line30-33	Discussion/paragragh1
Reporting of Conclusions			
32	Consideration of alternative explanations for observed results	Page9/line4-9	Conclusions/paragragh1
33	Generalization of the conclusions (ie, appropriate for the data presented and within the domain of the literature review)	Page8/line33-Pge9/line1	Discussion/paragragh5
34	Guidelines for future research	Page9/line4-9	Conclusions/Paragargh1
35	Disclosure of funding source	Page9/line12-14	Conclusions/Paragargh2

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*As the checklist was provided upon initial submission, the page number/line number reported may be changed due to copy editing and may not be referable in the published version. In this case, the section/paragraph may be used as an alternative reference.